Speech Templates

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A quick-fill guide for every speaker role — 4-minute speech version.

How to use this: fill in the blanks as you prep. Anything in [brackets] is a placeholder: replace it with your own answer, and don't say the brackets out loud. Times are approximate. it's OK to run a little over or under.

Min. = the fewest short sentences (about 8–10 words each) you should write for that part. Write more if you have time. Lines like Say: "Because ___..." are already one sentence.

The Toolkit (read once, use for every speech)

Every argument has 3 parts: Claim → Mechanism → Impact

Claim: what you are arguing. Mechanism: why it is right, or how it works (put an example here if it helps). Impact: characterize who is affected and how, then land why it matters.

Minimum: Claim 1 short sentence, Mechanism 2 (aim for 3: because... → so... → for example...), Impact 1 (who is affected and why it matters). Write more if you have time.

Claim	*Schools should not give homework on weekends.*
Mechanism	*Kids need real rest and family time. So they come back focused on Monday. For example, adults get weekends off work and come back more productive.*
Impact	*Students would feel less stressed and have more energy during the school week. That matters because it affects millions of students, every week, all school year.*

Choosing your arguments (PM & LO): let the motion decide

Not every motion needs both a principle and a practical argument. Don't force one.

Practical motion	*About money, safety, or results (e.g. build more bike lanes). Use two practical arguments. Don't invent a moral right.*
Principle motion	*About fairness, rights, or justice (e.g. everyone deserves a second chance). Use two principle arguments. Don't argue about money or convenience.*
Mixed motion	*A real action that clashes with a deep value (e.g. make voting compulsory). Use one principle and one practical argument — if the judge doubts one, you can still win on the other.*

So-what test: for a practical point, ask "Why does that matter?" The answer should reach people (lives, safety, fairness). For a principle, ask "What happens in the real world?", if the answer is chaos, your principle is weak.

Rebutting an argument: aim high

There are 5 ways to answer a point, from weakest to strongest. Spend most of your time on levels 4 and 5.

1 Wrong facts (weakest)	*Say: "That fact is wrong because..." Their idea still stands, so don't stop here.*
2 Too small or too slow	*Say: "This only affects a few people, takes too long to matter, or would happen anyway."*
3 Chain breaks	*Say: "Their step A does not lead to step B, because people would really..."*
4 Root idea (aim here)	*Say: "Their whole argument assumes ___, and that is false because..." If the root falls, everything on top falls too.*
5 Even if (aim here)	*Say: "Even if everything they said works, we still win because..." The safest answer: it works even if the judge believes them.*

Pattern: say what they said → say why it is wrong (aim for levels 4–5) → add an "Even if".

Weighing tools (Whip and Reply speakers): pick ONE for each clash

These show WHY you win a clash. Use one tool per clash. Don't use them all.

Two worlds	*(counterfactual) "If we change only this one thing, the world looks like ___. Without it, ___."*
Even if	*"Even if they are right that ___, we still win because ___." (Min. 1 sentence)*
Bigger	*(magnitude) "Ours affects more people: ___ compared to ___."*
Hard to undo	*(reversibility) "Their harm can be fixed later, but ours cannot be undone."*
New change	*(marginality) "Our benefit only happens because of our side. Theirs would happen anyway."*
Most vulnerable	*"The people who need protection most are ___, and only our side protects them."*
Rights first	*"A basic right like ___ must come before money or convenience."*
Comes first	*(prerequisite) "Their point cannot happen without ours, so ours comes first."*
Tipping point	*"It is already close to breaking, and their side pushes it over."*

PM — Prime Minister

First Government Speech

Time: 4 minutes (approximate; adjust flexibly)

Section	Time
Motion, definition & model	~40 sec
The problem	~20 sec
Signposting	~20 sec
Substantive 1	~1 min 5 sec
Substantive 2	~1 min 5 sec
Final call to action	~30 sec

Motion, definition & model:

Set the stage: say the motion, what the key words mean, and what your plan is. If you do not define it, the opposition will.

Motion, definition & model	
Motion. Say: "Today's motion is..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: the motion)
Definition. Say: "By ___, we mean..."	Word: _____ Means: _____ (Min. 1 sentence per word; add a 2nd word only if needed)
Model. Say: "Our plan is simple:..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: what changes and who does it; skip for a value/idea motion)

The problem (what is wrong now):

Before you sell your solution, show what is wrong.

The problem	
The harm or wrong. Say: "Right now, the problem is..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: what is wrong right now, who is hurt or treated unfairly, and why nothing is fixing it)

Signposting. Say: "Our case has three arguments..."

A few words each — just the topic. You give the first two; the DPM gives the third. Together = 1 sentence.

1) _____

2) _____

3) _____

Substantive 1:

Your strongest argument. Choose the type that fits your motion (practical, principle, or mixed). See "Choosing your arguments" in the Toolkit.

Substantive 1 (~65 sec)	
Claim. Say: "My first point is..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence)
Mechanism. Say: "This is true because..."	_____ (Min. 2 sentences, aim for 3: why is it right, or how does it work? Say it as because... → so... → for example...)
Impact. Say: "This matters because..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: who is affected and why it is important, e.g. many people, long-lasting)

Substantive 2:

Your second argument. Again, the type that fits your motion. For a practical one, go step by step: change only one thing (A), show how people respond (B), then what that leads to (C).

Substantive 2 (~65 sec)	
Claim. Say: "My second point is..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence)
Mechanism. Say: "This is true because..."	_____ (Min. 2 sentences, aim for 3: why is it right, or how does it work? Say it as because... → so... → for example...)
Impact. Say: "This matters because..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: who is affected and why it is important, e.g. many people, long-lasting)

Final call to action

Short and powerful: leave a strong impression before the opposition rises.

Say: "Because _____, and because _____, we proudly propose this motion. Thank you." (a few words each: the problem, our solution)

LO — Leader of Opposition

First Opposition Speech

Time: 4 minutes (approximate; adjust flexibly)

Section	Time
Clash of visions & re-framing	~50 sec
Direct rebuttal to the PM	~45 sec
Signposting	~20 sec
Substantive 1	~52 sec
Substantive 2	~48 sec
Structural promise	~25 sec

Clash of visions & re-framing:

Don't start with random rebuttals. First pit your world against the Prime Minister's world and reject their story.

Clash of visions	
Motion. Say: "Today's motion is..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: the motion)
Their story. Say: "The Prime Minister wants you to believe..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: their story, e.g. the status quo is a crisis)
Our answer. Say: "We reject this. The real debate is about..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: what this debate is really about, in your favor)

Direct rebuttal to the PM:

SAY (open): *"Let me answer the Prime Minister's strongest argument."*

Pick the PM's strongest argument. Attack the idea underneath, not just a small fact (see "Rebutting an argument" in the Toolkit).

	They said... (a few words)	But that's wrong because... (min. 1 sentence)	Even if they're right, we still win because... (min. 1 sentence)
PM's strongest point	_____	_____	_____

SAY (close): *"Now, to our own case."*

Signposting — say: "Our case has three arguments..."

A few words each — just the topic. You give the first two; the DLO gives the third. Together = 1 sentence.

1) _____

2) _____

3) _____

Substantive 1:

Your strongest argument. Choose the type that fits your motion (practical, principle, or mixed). See "Choosing your arguments" in the Toolkit.

Substantive 1 (~52 sec)	
Claim. Say: "My first point is..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence)
Mechanism. Say: "This is true because..."	_____ (Min. 2 sentences: why is it right, or how does it work? Say it as because... → so... A 3rd, for example..., only if you have time)
Impact. Say: "This matters because..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: who is affected and why it is important, e.g. many people, long-lasting)

Substantive 2:

Your second argument. Again, the type that fits your motion. For a practical one, go step by step: change only one thing (A), show how people respond (B), then what that leads to (C).

Substantive 2 (~48 sec)	
Claim. Say: "My second point is..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence)
Mechanism. Say: "This is true because..."	_____ (Min. 2 sentences: why is it right, or how does it work? Say it as because... → so... A 3rd, for example..., only if you have time)
Impact. Say: "This matters because..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: who is affected and why it is important, e.g. many people, long-lasting)

Structural promise

Short and sharp: show you built a strong base and set up your Deputy.

Say: "Because we _____ and _____, we proudly oppose this motion. Thank you." (a few words each: how we re-framed the debate, what we proved)

DPM / DLO — Deputy Speeches

Deputy Prime Minister / Deputy Leader of Opposition

Time: 4 minutes (approximate; adjust flexibly)

Section	Time
Framing & re-centering	~35 sec
Integrated rebuttal	~1 min 5 sec
Rebuilding your Leader's case	~50 sec
Your new argument	~1 min
Structural summary	~30 sec

DPM: focus on the LO's two arguments. DLO: may range across the whole government case, including the DPM's argument.

Framing & re-centering:

Don't jump straight into point-by-point rebuttal. First fix what this debate is really about. The last speaker may have twisted your team's case.

Framing	
Their version. Say: "They want you to believe this debate is about..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: what the last speaker made it about)
Our version. Say: "But the real debate is about..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: what our Leader's case is really about)

Rebuttal (their 2 main arguments):

Answer their Leader's 2 main arguments. Attack the idea underneath each, not just a small fact (see "Rebutting an argument" in the Toolkit).

	They said... (a few words)	But that's wrong because... (min. 1 sentence)	Even if they're right, we still win because... (min. 1 sentence)
Their argument 1	_____	_____	_____
Their argument 2	_____	_____	_____

Rebuilding your Leader's case:

Your team's first speech was attacked. Show it survived, and go deeper with a better explanation, a number, or an example. Say: "They attacked our Leader's point on ___ by saying ___. But that fails because ___."

	They attacked... (a few words)	By saying... (a few words)	This fails because (min. 2 sentences: add a deeper reason or example)
Attack	_____	_____	_____

Your new argument:

Bring ONE brand-new argument your Leader did not cover. For example a new group of people affected, or a long-term effect.

Your new argument (~60 sec)	
Claim. Say: "My third point is..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence)
Mechanism. Say: "This is true because..."	_____ (Min. 2 sentences, aim for 3: why is it right, or how does it work? Say it as because... → so... → for example...)
Impact. Say: "This matters because..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: who is affected and why it is important, e.g. many people, long-lasting)

Structural summary

Short and sharp. Show that your team is the strongest in the round.

Say: "Because we defended _____ and added _____, we proudly stand by this motion. Thank you." (a few words each: our Leader's case, your new argument)

GW / OW — Whip Speeches

Government Whip / Opposition Whip

Time: 4 minutes (approximate; adjust flexibly)

Section	Time
Direct rebuttal	~40 sec
Clash 1	~1 min 15 sec
Clash 2	~1 min 10 sec
Final weighing	~30 sec
Final ballot	~25 sec

Direct rebuttal:

Start by answering the speaker who spoke right before you.

Direct rebuttal	
Their last point. Say: "The last speaker said..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: their biggest or newest point)
Answer it. Say: "But that fails because..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: attack the idea underneath) — then say: "Now, to the main clashes."

Clashes:

Say to open: "Now, there are two clashes today." Pick the 2 biggest disagreements. No new arguments. Use what your team already said.

Clash 1	
Clash. Say: "The first clash was..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: a question both sides fought over, e.g. "Do students deserve free weekends?")
They said. Say: "They said..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: their strongest argument)
We said. Say: "But our team already showed..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: proof your team already gave)
Why we win. Say: "We win because..."	Tool: _____ We win because: _____ (Min. 1 sentence: pick ONE tool from the Weighing Tools in the Toolkit) — then say: "So we win this clash."
Clash 2	
Clash. Say: "The second clash was..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: a question both sides fought over, e.g. "Do students learn better with weekend homework?")
They said. Say: "They said..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: their strongest argument)
We said. Say: "But our team already showed..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: proof your team already gave)
Why we win. Say: "We win because..."	Tool: _____ We win because: _____ (Min. 1 sentence: pick ONE tool from the Weighing Tools in the Toolkit) — then say: "So we win this clash."

Last, one weighing of why your team wins overall:

Final weighing	
Overall. Say: "Overall, we win because..."	We win because: _____ (Min. 1 sentence: pick ONE tool from the Weighing Tools in the Toolkit)

Final ballot

Short and sharp: give the judge a clear reason to vote for your side.

Say: "Because we won on _____ and on _____, the ballot belongs to our side. Thank you." (your two biggest clashes, a few words each)

Reply Speech

PM or LO / DPM or DLO

Time: 2 minutes (approximate — adjust flexibly)

No new arguments in this speech. Pick the 2 biggest clashes. Whatever the debate was really about.

Section	Time
Opening frame	~25 sec
Clash 1	~40 sec
Clash 2	~40 sec
Final ballot	~15 sec

Opening frame	
Two visions. Say: "You must choose between two visions of the world."	(nothing to write — say it from memory)
The clashes. Say: "The debate came down to two clashes..."	First: _____ Second: _____ (a few words each, e.g. "Who protects students better?")
Clash 1	
Their world. Say: "On the first clash, in their world..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: what happens in their world, and why it fails)
Our world. Say: "In our world..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: what happens in our world instead)
Why we win. Say: "We win this clash because..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: pick ONE weighing tool from the Toolkit if it helps)
Clash 2	
Their world. Say: "On the second clash, in their world..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: what happens in their world, and why it fails)
Our world. Say: "In our world..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: what happens in our world instead)
Why we win. Say: "We win this clash because..."	_____ (Min. 1 sentence: pick ONE weighing tool from the Toolkit if it helps)

Final ballot

Say: "Because our world _____, we proudly propose/oppose this motion. Thank you." (a few words: why our world is better)